

A collection of playing cards is displayed. In the foreground, a royal flush in spades is laid out, showing the 10, 9, 8, 7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, and Ace of spades. Behind this, several other cards are visible, including the King, Queen, Jack, and 10 of clubs; the Ace, 8, 6, 4, and 2 of hearts; the Queen, 6, 4, and 3 of diamonds; and the 10, 9, 8, 7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, and Ace of diamonds. The cards are arranged in a way that suggests a game in progress.

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Count Sure Winners				
				Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

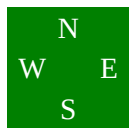
♠ 7 2
♥ Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 9 2
♣ Q 7 3

♠ 10 9 8 6 5 3

♥ K 7

♦ 8 4

♣ A K J



♠ A 4

♥ J 9 5

♦ K 10 7 5

♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A 8 6 2

♦ Q 6 3

♣ 10 9 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Don't think of passing. With 11 HCP and 2 length points you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You must bid and you want to show that you have a bare minimum. You don't want to say 2NT because of that doubleton nothing ♦. So you rebid your 6-card ♠ suit. Partner bids 4 ♠ and everybody passes.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. West wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. West wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

You have already lost the 2 ♦ s and you sure can't escape losing the Ace of trumps. So you mustnot lose a ♣ trick. So your Plan will be to pull trumps, then finesse West for the ♣ Q.

You ruff the third ♦, play ♠ s until the ♠ A appears. When you regain the lead you pull any outstanding trumps, play one high ♣, (in case someone has a singleton ♣ Q), then enter dummy with the ♥ A and make the ♣ finesse. Half of the time you make the contract, the other half you don't.

You were lucky that the ♣ Q was with West.

It's never great when the success of your contract depends on a finesse, but sometimes that's your only hope - a 50% chance.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ K Q 7 6

♠ A 7

♥ K 6 5 3

♦ 7 6 2

♣ 10 5 4 3



♠ K Q 10 3

♥ A 4

♦ Q J 10 5

♣ A J 2

♠ 9 8 5 2

♥ J 10 9 8 2

♦ K 4

♣ 9 8

West

North

East

South

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Your only hope is to win 8 more tricks before you lose the lead. That means the ♦ finesse had better work. At trick 2 you lead your ♦ Q, playing low from dummy if South doesn't cover. Repeat the finesse as necessary. When South has the ♦ K you will make your contract, and when North has the ♦ K you will go down. That's a 50% chance, just like most finesses. But remember, if you had tried to establish the ♠ suit instead of taking the finesse your chance of making 3NT would be 0%.

You can see what could have happened if you had tried to sneak even one ♠ trick. North would have grabbed the ♠ A and played a small ♥. South would have happily taken 4 ♥ tricks and you would be down 1.

You have a very solid 17 points and a balanced hand. You open 1NT. Partner responds 3NT and you pass.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥ J. You hopefully put on the ♥ Q, but North plays the ♥ K.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥ J. You hopefully put on the ♥ Q, but North plays the ♥ K.

Winners: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 4 : Total = 6

A hold-up won't help unless North had a doubleton ♥, giving South a 7-card suit. So you win your ♥ A. The ♠ suit is solid after the ♠ A is played, but before you could enjoy those 3 tricks the defenders would have really enjoyed a bunch of ♥ s.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

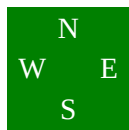
♠ K 6 3
 ♥ Q J 10 8 3
 ♦ J
 ♣ K J 6 2

♠ Q 10 9 8

♥ A 5

♦ 7 5 4 2

♣ 9 7 3



♠ J 7 5 4
 ♥ 9 6
 ♦ K Q 10 9
 ♣ Q 8 4

♠ A 2

♥ K 7 4 2

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ A 10 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT

All Pass

1NT by South
 entry to dummy you must save it until the right time.

Win the first trick with the ♥K. Then play ♠A followed by ♠2. Continue playing ♠s until the ♠K is forced out. Win whatever they play next and play your other winners. You cannot be stopped from taking 7 tricks.

Imagine what would have happened if you had taken the first trick with dummy's ♥A.

What would you try next? A ♠ finesse? Whether West took his ♠K right then or later you would go down. You could never reach dummy again.

You have 7 points so you know your side does not have a game. You also have no reason to think there is any better contract than 1NT. So you pass.

North would play 1NT. To make life more convenient the hands will be rotated so that South becomes declarer.

South plays 1NT. West leads the ♥Q.

South plays 1NT. West leads the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

You need two more winners. Even if the ♦s split 3-2 you can get only one more from that suit. So clearly you must use the ♠ suit. Since you have only one